

Chapter 124-2

Just as Liang Shi was about to send a voice message to confirm, another message came from the other party, the voice processed through a voice changer: "If you call the police now, I'll make sure you receive Xu Qingzhu's memorial photo."

Liang Shi didn't dare take the risk. She didn't even have time to change clothes—she just switched to a pair of comfortable flat shoes and hurried out the door.

Outside was a torrential downpour, which matched the strong wind perfectly.

The violent wind and rain even carried tree branches onto the road. Liang Shi glanced at the navigation—it would still take forty-nine minutes to get there, and that was the shortest distance, not accounting for traffic.

After driving for a while, Liang Shi's mind finally wasn't a chaotic mess anymore, and she could spare some mental space to think about this matter.

She didn't dare use the phone number the other party had contacted her with to make calls. Instead, she switched to a phone number she had never used before and called Zhao Xuning.

Zhao Xuning's side was slow to answer, but she finally picked up.

Her voice was hoarse and carried impatience—obvious signs of being woken up. Liang Shi hadn't expected her to be sleeping at this hour, but since the call had gone through, Zhao Xuning was the only person she could trust right now.

"You'd better have something important." Zhao Xuning said through gritted teeth.

Liang Shi ignored her grumpiness from being woken up. Her foot on the accelerator was trembling, her entire body was cold, yet she persisted through sheer bodily instinct. Although her voice was shaking, every word was bitten out with exceptional clarity: "Zhao Xuning, listen to me."

"Near Provincial Road 209 on Xihui Road, in the former abandoned chemical factory not far from the highway exit, a kidnapping has occurred. The kidnapped victim is a woman. The kidnapper threatened to kill her if the police are called, so the police can depart ten minutes from now. Please make sure the police turn off their sirens and quietly set up a perimeter around the area."

Liang Shi was maintaining maximum rationality as she spoke to Zhao Xuning. "Once they hear an alarm sound from inside, I hope the police will move in immediately. I will do my best to cooperate from inside. The nature of this kidnapping case seems more like revenge than robbery, so I will try my best to stall the kidnapper and buy time for the police to set up."

She said all this in one breath. Zhao Xuning on the other end of the phone was stunned for a moment, then quickly reacted: "Xu Qingzhu was kidnapped?"

Liang Shi's voice trembled: "Yes, I'm on my way to rescue her—though I might just be walking into a trap. That's why I think we still need to call the police."

It wasn't that her combat ability wasn't high enough; the most important thing was that Xu Qingzhu was in the other party's hands.

And also...

Liang Shi said coldly: "Also, the kidnapper is very likely the washed-up celebrity Chen Liuying. You can track this phone of mine now so you'll be able to pinpoint my location, but you need to be quick. If possible, please have the police check Chen Liuying's travel history, especially any records of her appearing near Minghui Jewelry. Of course, it's best not to leak the information that Xu Qingzhu has been kidnapped, otherwise it will affect Minghui Jewelry if it gets out."

That was Xu Qingzhu's life's work. Liang Shi wanted to protect it for her.

After hearing all this, all of Zhao Xuning's grumpiness from being woken up vanished completely. She simply reminded her: "Be careful in all things."

Liang Shi responded with an "mm."

Zhao Xuning said: "I'll take care of all these things for you."

Liang Shi said in a muffled voice: "Thank you."

There was even a hint of tragic heroism in her tone.

It was precisely because she trusted Zhao Xuning that Liang Shi chose to call her.

Zhao Xuning's network of connections here was much stronger than hers, so having Zhao Xuning handle this would be far more efficient than doing it herself.

After hanging up the phone, Liang Shi happened to turn a corner. Ahead was a wide-open road. She stepped on the accelerator and sped forward.

The windshield wipers kept scraping across the glass. The sky was growing darker. The fine threads of rain looked especially desolate under the dim yellow streetlights. The car kept passing by other vehicles.

Gradually disappearing from sight.